

Parallel Four

Harness the Power of Observation

Observation is disciplined intelligence gathering fueled by curiosity and attention to people, patterns, and change.

Leadership Model: OBSERVE

Put It into Play

Reflection Questions

Make time to reflect before you lead forward.

1. What assumptions am I making, and who might see the situation differently?

2. What distractions are limiting my awareness of people, patterns, and change?

3. Am I observing firsthand and validating what I think I see before responding?

Team Conversation Prompts

Use these questions to spark meaningful conversations with your team.

1. What patterns or changes are we noticing that deserve more attention?

2. What are people communicating without saying it, and what remains unsaid?

3. What additional context do we need, and who should we talk with?

4. What action do our observations require, and how will we verify its impact?

Manager Conversation Prompts

Use these questions during your next one-on-one or performance discussion.

1. Where might my assumptions be limiting what I notice or understand?

2. What signals or emerging issues do you see that I may be overlooking?

3. How could I improve my follow-through after identifying an issue or opportunity?

Take Action

Which one or two of these actions would benefit my team and our performance most?

1. I will set aside distractions and observe a team situation firsthand.

2. I will seek a different perspective and challenge one assumption I am making.

3. I will look for patterns and validate an observation through questions and additional context.

4. I will initiate a conversation or action to address an emerging issue early.

5. I will review the impact of my response and adjust my approach based on what I learn.

